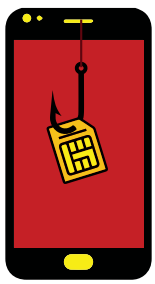


STEP 3

Fraudsters get a new SIM issued for the mobile number registered with the bank account using forged ID documents, such as Aadhaar, and a fake police complaint/ report about loss of mobile phone.



STEP 4

Once the new SIM has been procured, a number porting request is immediately submitted with a new mobile service provider. The porting takes a few days, during which funds are siphoned off. With the SIM and mobile service provider changed, the account holder does not get SMS alerts about illegal withdrawals from the account.



STEP 5

Cloned cheques are invariably presented for clearance at the bank's branches in other states. After a cloned cheque gets credited, the funds are quickly transferred to accounts opened in the name of minions—those at the bottom of the fraud network. The money is then withdrawn at ATMs.

working for two Jamshedpur-based fraudsters, Vinay Singh and Jagjot Singh. The arrest of Vinay and Jagjot threw up incriminating evidence, including documents allegedly linking them to the forgery. Police say the investigation revealed that the duo had also siphoned off Rs 1.17 crore from the bank account of the Bihar science and technology department in 2019.

The police have identified Ved Prakash, a resident of Jharkhand, as the mastermind of the MPLADS account scam and are hunting for him. Police suspect it all started as an insider job with an employee of BOB's Chhapra branch identifying Sigriwal's account as 'vulnerable', since it had lot of funds and, like many government department accounts, was possibly not being monitored closely. He allegedly provided the fraudsters details of the check book, including

A HIGH REWARDS, LOW RISK SCAM

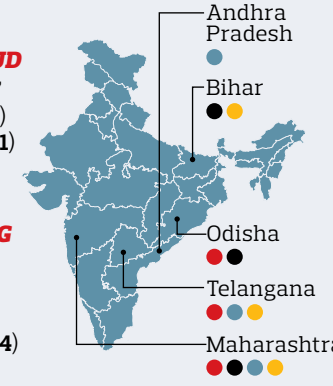
By the end of each bank working day in 2020-21, Indian banks had been defrauded of Rs 80 lakh by way of forged cheques and card/ internet frauds. The loss amounted to over Rs 1 crore if other kinds of bank scams were taken into account. Since banks—as per RBI policy—are mandated to compensate account holders for the funds, the victims of such scams invariably lose interest in the progress of the investigation. With time, the overworked police also drop these cases off their priority list. This is why the swindled money is not recovered in a majority of the cases.

According to the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), the police registered 4,047 cases of online banking frauds in 2020 even as investigation was pending in 2,267 such cases from previous years. Trials, on an average, had been completed in just 90 cases a year. In 2020, police submitted final reports in 3,871 cases, mentioning "cases true but insufficient evidence or accused untraced". The bulk of these cases (2,460) were of cyber fraud. The NCRB's 2020 report also found more than 440,000 cases of forgery, cheating and fraud pending court trials.

STATES OF CONCERN

ONLINE BANKING FRAUD
Total cases 4,047
Telangana (**1,405**)
Maharashtra (**821**)
Odisha (**549**)

ATM HACKING
Total cases 2,160
Bihar (**642**)
Odisha (**362**)
Maharashtra (**324**)



STOLEN OTP FRAUD
Total cases 1,093
Telangana (**525**)
Maharashtra (**239**)
Andhra Pradesh (**140**)

CREDIT/ DEBIT CARD FRAUD
Total cases 1,194
Bihar (**493**)
Telangana (**252**)
Maharashtra (**180**)

Figures for top-three states in 2020
Source: National Crime Records Bureau